

June

22

1869

Wacky wheel

US inventor Georg Bergner beat his rivals to file the first patent for a vehicle called a monowheel – a large, pedal-powered wheel inside which the rider would sit. It failed to catch on.



Born this day

1949 Meryl Streep, US actor. She has been nominated for more than 20 Oscars – far more than any other actor – and has won three times, for her roles in *Kramer vs Kramer*, *Sophie's Choice*, and *The Iron Lady*.

1960 Erin Brockovich, US environmental activist. Her successful case against Pacific Gas & Electric company for polluting groundwater inspired a Hollywood film.

1948

Windrush generation

Hundreds of passengers from the Caribbean on the ship *Empire Windrush* set foot on British soil. The contribution these migrants made to the UK is now celebrated on this date as Windrush Day.



1986

Greatest goal

At a FIFA World Cup game in Mexico, Argentinian footballer Diego Maradona weaved past three English players to score

one of the greatest goals in football history. Argentina won the match 2–1 and went on to win the World Cup.



Also on this day

1940 France surrendered to Germany in World War II, and signed an agreement that brought much of the country under Nazi rule.

1941 Nazi Germany launched Operation Barbarossa, a surprise invasion of the Soviet Union. In time, the Soviet army pushed the Germans back.

1978 Charon, the largest of Pluto's five moons, was discovered by US astronomers James Christy and Robert Harrington.